Demand is most concrete in payments and trading, where companies already report live deployments

Use case	*What must stay private*	*Evidence so far*	*Who is building or backing it*
Payments and payroll *Company-reported deployments*	Salaries, supplier invoices and treasury movements	Zama and Bron report payroll on Ethereum using confidential USDT, with amounts encrypted	Zama, Bron, Aleo
Trading and tokenised assets *Company-reported deployments*	Orders, positions and holdings	Zama reports a confidential OTC trade involving GSR; Dfns has added confidential tokens to its wallet platform	Zama, Dfns *Backed by* Variant
Private computation and AI *Building*	Customer data and model inputs	Computation over shared private data with secure hardware, and private computation infrastructure	Seismic, Nillion *Backed by* a16z, Hack VC
Programmable privacy *Building*	Hidden inputs for sealed-bid auctions, private ballots and strategy games	Reusable tools, so each application does not need its own cryptography	Fhenix, Zama, Aztec, Noir *Backed by* Multicoin, a16z

What it means

Payments and trading lead because the cost of exposure is direct and easy to measure. Every row still reveals who is transacting, and from where, unless the connection itself is private.

Note: Deployments are company-reported and not independently verified. *Sources:* Zama and Bron; Aleo; Variant, Crypto privacy landscape; Zama, institutional applications; Dfns and Zama; a16z, Investing in Seismic; Hack VC; Multicoin, The dawn of onchain FHE; a16z, Investing in Aztec.